

Task Force Lima identified that **traditional, hardware-centric procurement processes significantly hinder** the unique requirements of Generative AI (GenAI), specifically its **continuous test, evaluation, verification, and validation (TEVV)** approaches.

The specific friction points identified include:

- **Incompatibility with Continuous Lifecycles:** Traditional procurement is designed for hardware with discrete development and production phases, whereas GenAI requires a continuous development pipeline and ongoing TEVV that does not fit into a "linear" lab-to-program model.
- **Static Maintenance vs. Dynamic Needs:** The maintenance requirements for GenAI models—which may require frequent updates due to data or concept drift—are often slowed by rigid procurement structures built for static hardware components.
- **Pace of Cybersecurity Authorization:** GenAI introduces unique cybersecurity concerns that evolve much faster than legacy network authorization (Authority to Operate, or ATO) processes and policies can accommodate. The traditional ATO process, which can take 6 to 18 months, acts as a major barrier to the rapid, iterative deployment of AI software.
- **Lack of Flexibility for Scaling:** Traditional processes lack the flexibility needed to quickly seize new opportunities or address emerging issues at the speed and scale required for operational advantage.
- **Resource Constraints:** Pilots are frequently challenged by a lack of access to compute resources and the high costs associated with them, which traditional budgeting and procurement frameworks (like PPBE) are often too slow or cumbersome to address effectively.

To overcome these friction points, the Task Force recommended evolving DoD policies to adopt **flexible, iterative acquisition pathways** that allow for "provisional authorizations" and embedding dedicated test and evaluation teams directly into pilot efforts.

Saved responses are view only